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The Cards

The Trader and the Nafs

THE WHOLE BOOK, COMPRESSED TO WHAT YOU CAN
GLANCE AT IN THE HEAT

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Tear these out. Tape them where you trade. The book was the understanding; these are the understanding compressed to what you can actually glance at in the heat, when there's no time to remember a chapter.



The NAFS Loop

run it the instant the impulse rises

N → A → F → S

- ◆ N — Notice. Catch the heat *as it rises*, before the negotiation. *The watcher wakes.*
- ◆ A — Assess. Name it: which disease? which lie? which self is reaching for the wheel?
- ◆ F — Fight. Apply the cure and break the state — step away, breathe, make *wudu*. Ask: *what did I already decide?*
- ◆ S — Submit. Hand the outcome to its Owner and execute the pre-made decision. *My part is done; the rest is His.*

The whole book in four moves. Loop it until it becomes not a rule you remember but a self you've become.

The Three Selves

where am I right now?

- ◆ Commanding (*al-ammāra*) — breaks the rule and feels nothing. Externalizes. Worships the outcome. The smooth, untroubled bottom.
- ◆ Reproaching (*al-lawwāma*) — breaks the rule and it tortures him. The conscience, back online. The painful, hopeful middle. *If reading this hurt, you're here.*
- ◆ Tranquil (*al-mutma'inna*) — follows the rule from settled nature, not strain. Feels the sting, doesn't obey it. The summit.

Which self is in the chair right now? You always know.

The Catalogue of Lies catch them in flight

THE LIE	WHAT IT DOES	THE TELL
"Today is different."	Creates an exception exactly when the rule is needed	the word <i>but</i> after a known rule
"I'll just..."	Shrinks the violation till it seems too small to matter	the word <i>just</i>
"To get back to even."	Smuggles in a goal the market doesn't know	reasoning about your <i>P&L</i> , not the setup
"I deserve this."	Turns good behavior into a license for bad	the word <i>deserve</i>
"It's basically my setup."	Erodes a precise rule into a vague approximation	<i>basically, sort of, close enough</i>
"I have a feeling about this one."	Dresses an impulse as insight	a "feeling" that's <i>urgent</i> and breaks the rule

The flicker comes first. The rationalization rushes in to smother it. Feel the flicker.

The Five Diseases name yours

1. Impatience (*ʿajala*) — can't sit in the gap between wanting and having. Cure: *sabr*. *Waiting is the trade.*
2. Greed — the bottomless hunger; attacks on your *best* days. Cure: contentment. *Richness is of the soul, not the balance.*
3. Fear — paralysis and panic, both. Cure: courage. *Pre-accept the loss. Size down till you can think.*
4. Pride (*kibr*) — can't be wrong; defends the ego with the balance. Cure: humility. *The price is the truth. Bow to it.*
5. Despair (*qunūṭ*) — quits the sound process in the normal slump. Cure: hope. *Giving up is the only guaranteed loss.*

Beneath all five: the love of wealth. Keep the money in your hand, never in your heart.

The Seven Strengths what I'm building

- ◆ Sabr — the strength to hold. *Reward without measure.*
- ◆ Tawakkul — tie the camel, release the outcome. *He is enough.*
- ◆ Taqwa — there is no empty room. *He sees this trade.*
- ◆ Muhasabah — reckon with yourself before the market does.
- ◆ Ikhlas — purify *why* you trade. *Would I do this if no one would ever know?*
- ◆ Ihsan — sharpen the blade where it doesn't count. *Work as though He sees the tape.*
- ◆ Shukr — the lens of gift. *Win met with gratitude, loss with patience.*

The Pre-Market Checklist before the heat

1. Begin from worship — don't let a chart be the first thing your heart touches.
2. Stillness + honest state check. *If I'm not fit to trade, I don't trade.*
3. Set the intention: *for the sake of Allah; the outcome is His, my conduct is mine.*
4. Enter the gaze: *I trade now under His sight, including the secret decisions.*
5. Affirm the covenant — read the rules, lock them against revision.
6. Write the plan — the lawmaker's contract the executor will obey.
7. Pre-accept the outcomes, especially the losses. Release them before you begin.

The battle is usually won or lost here, in the fifteen quiet minutes most traders never take.

The Daily Reckoning after the close

1. Process grade /10 — behavior only, *before* you look at P&L.
2. Covenant audit — kept fully? If broken: which rule, what moment, what state and trigger?
3. Diagnosis — which disease, which lie (exact words), which self was driving?
4. Honest cause — in your specific act. Not the market. Not your whole self.
5. Turning-back — own the fault to your Lord, ask forgiveness, affirm the door is open.
6. One correction — a single implementable change for tomorrow. Not ten. One.
7. The good — what went right (votes for the identity), and the good extracted from the day.

The session isn't over when the market closes. It's over when you've told yourself the truth about it.

The Whole Book on One Card

You are not a trader trying to beat the market.

You are a soul trying to master itself, handed an unusually honest arena to do the work.

The knowing was never the problem. The doing was.

Don't aim to become profitable. Become the kind of man profit is safe to give.

Trade as worship. Lose as a believer. Win as a servant.

The market revealed your weakness. Let it now witness your mastery.

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